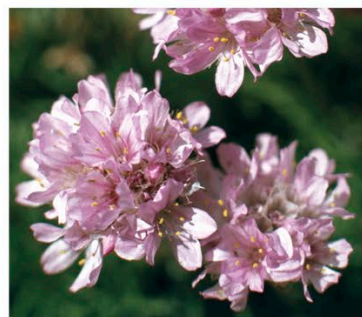




Plants for cracks in walls and paving

Stone or old brick walls punctuated with small, spreading plants nestling in the cracks transform an ordinary landscaping feature into a focal point.

You can also soften the sharp outlines of paths and patios with colorful, low-growing plants squeezed between the slabs and bricks. Designs are most effective where the plants look as though they have self-seeded, and this is one option, using plants, such as sweet alyssum and Mexican fleabane. These grow easily from seed, given a little soil in which to germinate. Alternatively, remove the mortar between bricks or paving stones, or eliminate one altogether. Wrap the roots of your young plants or plugs in sticky, clay-rich soil and wedge them into the gap. Drizzle carefully with water until the plants have established.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Armeria maritima

THRIFT A clump-forming evergreen perennial with grasslike dark green leaves. Round heads of small white to pink flowers appear on slim stems in summer. Use it to fill gaps in paving; suitable for coastal areas.

↑4in (10cm) ↔6in (15cm)

☀ Z4–8 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

Aubrieta 'Argenteovariegata'

ROCK CRESS This trailing evergreen perennial forms mats of oval green leaves with cream edges. Small pinkish lavender flowers cover the plant throughout spring. Ideal for cracks in walls and paving. Cut back after flowering.

↑2in (5cm) ↔6in (15cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Aurinia saxatilis

BASKET OF GOLD A clump-forming evergreen perennial with oval, hairy gray-green leaves. From spring to summer, it produces a mass of tiny chrome-yellow flowers on slim stems. Use it to brighten up walls and paving.

↑9in (23cm) ↔12in (30cm)

☀ Z4–7



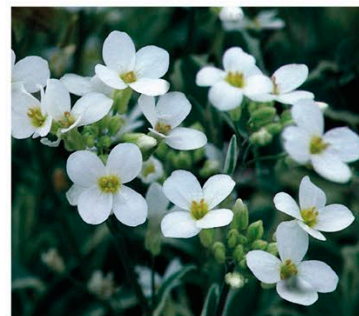
BULB MEDIUM

Allium schoenoprasum

CHIVES A clump-forming, upright deciduous bulb with narrow, hollow, dark green edible leaves. In summer, it produces fluffy, pale purple pompon flower heads on slim stems. Ideal for paving cracks and tight spaces.

↑12in (30cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Arabis alpina subsp. *caucasica*

WALL ROCK CRESS A mat-forming evergreen perennial with small, hairy, gray-green leaves and, from early spring to early summer, masses of small white flowers. Grow it in wall or paving cracks.

↑↔6in (15cm)

☀ Z4–7



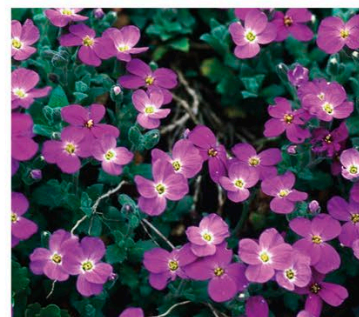
SHRUB SMALL

Calluna vulgaris

SCOTCH HEATHER A spreading evergreen shrub with upright stems covered with tiny bright green leaves and pink, white, or red blooms from midsummer to late fall. 'Spring Cream' (above) has white flowers and cream-colored new shoots in early summer.

↑24in (60cm) ↔30in (75cm)

☀ ㅁ Z4–6



PERENNIAL SMALL

Aubrieta deltoidea

AUBRETIA This small, ground-hugging evergreen perennial forms spreading stems of rounded gray-green leaves and masses of pale mauve flowers in spring. 'Whitewell Gem' bears hundreds of violet-purple blooms.

↑2in (5cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Campanula carpatica

CARPATHIAN HAREBELL This clump-forming perennial produces a carpet of heart-shaped green leaves and open bell-shaped, violet-blue or white flowers throughout summer. Use it to fill gaps in walls and paving.

↑4in (10cm) ↔12in (30cm)

☀ Z4–7